

Within limits, above the guideline

Five years of annual PM_{2.5} readings, checked against EU and WHO standards

THE CLAIM

“...well within the considerably less stringent annual limits set by the EU for PM_{2.5}.”

Newsbook, 18 July 2025

The underlying figures were tabled in Parliamentary Question 29696.

The Minister's answer tables data; it does not itself state that they comply.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

23 below 25
10 EEA match

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

23 / 23

Above WHO's guideline

All reported annual means exceed the 5 µg/m³ health-based guideline.

23 / 23

Within the historical EU limit

Every available value is below the 25 µg/m³ legal limit for 2020–2024.

2 missing

St Paul's Bay

The annex lists n/a for 2020 and 2021, so full five-station coverage is not shown.

14 / 23

Above the 2030 EU standard

Fourteen values exceed 10 µg/m³, the standard due by 2030—not a limit for these past years.

10 / 11

EEA values match

One cross-check differs: Attard 2024, 12.122 vs 11.9 in the annex.

FAIR TO SAY

The annex's 23 values all meet the historical EU limit and exceed WHO guidance. The partial EEA check broadly agrees but differs for Attard in 2024; the two St Paul's Bay n/a values remain unresolved.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ ERA's validated annual series and data-completeness notes.

☐ An explanation of the Attard 2024 difference.

☐ The missing St Paul's Bay values for 2020 and 2021, if available.

☐ Keep the 2030 EU standard distinct from past compliance.